

WeChat coffee gifting

China's top messaging app, WeChat is partnering with Starbucks. Users in China can now gift friends a coffee via chat <http://dgit.in/Chatcoffee>



Battery/Memory/Stylus

ChargeWrite is a \$29 device that has a pen, a stylus, and 1,000 mAh battery pack with a Lightning and Micro USB jack. <http://dgit.in/chargeWrite>

Smartphones

just like in life, first impressions are important.

To test displays, we use a combination of colour charts, high resolution images, black and white saturation tests and an HTC Instruments luminance meter to check the brightness of the display. The last test is done in a completely dark room, to cut off as much ambient light as possible. We turn off the display's auto-brightness feature, so as to provide an even playing field for all phones.

For the uninitiated, brightness is a subjective term, which can differ from person to person. What you find "bright" may not be up to our standards. It depends on things like ambient light and very importantly, the person's eyes. Luminance on the other hand, reflects the amount of light that is emitted by the display, giving an objective view of what can be considered bright.

After testing, the Lenovo P2 and Honor 6X came out on top, in terms of luminance, with ratings of 692 Lux and 660 Lux, respectively. However, the P2's Super AMOLED produces punchier colours, making the display vibrant and more colourful. The LTPS panel on the Honor 6X still needs backlights to light it up, which affects colour reproduction. However, the AMOLED panel on the P2 can turn individual pixels on and off, controlling colour reproduction minutely. Of course, the easiest way to spot this difference is through testing blacks.

The combination of brightness and good colours makes the P2 the most attractive display out here, and Lenovo has added a premium feel by making it resistant to fingerprints as well.

DESIGN

Now that we're through with the main elements of testing, we're left with design. In our opinion, design is never the first priority in the under 20k segment, although that doesn't mean one can get away with anything. In this test, 50% weightage has been given to performance, while 30% and 20% are reserved for features and design, respectively.

It is easy to spot the similarities between the ZTE Blade A2 Plus, Xiaomi Redmi Note 4, Lenovo K6 Note, ZTE Nubia N1 and Asus Zenfone 3 Laser. In fact, the Honor 6X and Coolpad Cool 1 follow the same design language, but their dual-cameras give them a distinct look.

The designs we really admire here are those on the Lenovo P2, Lenovo Z2 Plus and the ZTE Nubia Z11 Mini. Both the Lenovo devices are made for single handed usage. They're both compact, which is even

more commendable for the larger Lenovo P2. Of course, the Lenovo Z2 Plus' smaller display makes it even more compact, however. It's glass-like back also feels different, if not absolutely premium.

The Nubia Z11 Mini is another phone that has a glass design, and the combination of a glass back, metal frame and compact dimensions makes it quite good as well. Overall, in terms of pure ergonomics, it's the Lenovo Z2 Plus that is most easy on your hands.

The Xiaomi Mi Max and Lenovo Phab 2 Plus are obviously not meant for ergonomics, but here we'd pick the Mi Max. This is because the Mi Max is thinner and hence easier to slip into your pocket. Yes, that isn't a prerequisite for large phablets, but we did say you can't get away with anything, right? The Lenovo Phab 2 Plus is too thick and heavy to use comfortably.

BEST PERFORMER: Lenovo Z2 Plus

It is no surprise that the Lenovo Z2 Plus comes out as the best performer. On some level, specifications do matter, and the Snapdragon 820 on the Lenovo Z2 Plus is simply too powerful for any other SoC in this comparison. We do implore you to read the performance section completely in order to make the right choice for yourself, though.

BEST BUY: LeEco Le 2

It's pretty much second in terms of performance, but the LeEco Le 2 edges out the Coolpad Cool 1 to become the best buy, purely on its pricing. The device currently costs ₹11,999, which makes it more value for money. However, if



Xiaomi Redmi Note 4

you do want a better camera, spending an extra ₹2000 on the Coolpad Cool 1 would be a good idea. The Le 2 excels in performance, design and many other aspects, but its camera is the weak link here. Interestingly, the camera is also the only real difference between the Le 2 and Cool 1.

EDITOR'S PICK: Xiaomi Redmi Note 4

The Snapdragon 625 on the Redmi Note 4 is meant for efficiency, and efficient is just what this smartphone is. It is neither the fastest, nor does it have the best battery life, and it's camera isn't the best in the business either. If you have a Redmi Note 3, this isn't worth "upgrading" to. However, if you want a new phone and want something that is dependable, the Xiaomi Redmi Note 4 is the perfect jack of all trades. 



LeEco Le 2